on 24 September 2014, making India the first nation to succeed on its first attempt to Mars, and ISRO the fourth space agency in the world as well as the first space agency in Asia to reach Mars orbit. Mangalyan was launched by PSLV-XL C25. On 18 June 2016 ISRO set a record with a launch of 20 satellites in a single payload. On 15 February 2017, ISRO launched 104 satellites in a single rocket (PSLV-C37) and created a world record. ISRO launched its heaviest rocket, Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle-Mark III (GSLV-Mk III), on 5 June 2017 and placed a communications satellite GSAT-19 in orbit. With this launch, ISRO became capable of launching 4 ton heavy satellites.

ISRO launched Chandran 2 on July 22, 2019, Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV-Mk III M1). It entered the Moon's orbit on August 20, 2019.



In 1989, Galileo Galilei was memorialized with the launch of a Jupiter-bound space probe bearing his name. During its 14-year voyage, the Galileo space probe and its detachable mini-probe, visited Venus, the asteroid Gaspra, observed the impact of Comet Shoemaker-Levy 9 on Jupiter, Europa, Callisto, IO, and Amalthea.

In order to avoid the possible contamination of one of Jupiter's moons, the Galileo space probe was purposely crashed into Jupiter at the end of its mission in September 2003.

Points to Remember

- The field of study of the universe is called astronomy.
- The universe consists of galaxies, planets, stars, meteorites, satellites and all other forms of matter and energy.
- The half Moon during the waxing period is called as first quarter and the half Moon during the waning period is called as third quarter.
- The word crescent refers to the phases where the Moon is less than half illuminated. The word gibbous refers to phases where the Moon is more than half illuminated.
- The reversal of direction of planets is called as 'retrograde motion'.
- The geocentric theory followed by the ancient people proposed that the Earth is at the centre and the Sun and other planets revolve around it.
- The helio-centric theory states that the Sun is at the centre and the planets revolve around it
- Galileo gave the observational evidence to support the heliocentric theory
- A galaxy is a large collection of stars or cluster of stars and celestial bodies held together by gravitational attraction.
- A constellation is a recognizable pattern of stars in the night sky when viewed from the Earth.
- An object that revolves around a planet in a stable and consistent orbit is called a satellite.
- The Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO) is the space agency of the Government of India headquartered in the city of Bangalore.

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